ADONAI

Episode 1, "In the Beginning"

The Opening (Genesis 1:1-2:7)

Shooting script, first draft, v1.3 2026-10-13

FADE IN:

EXT./INT. THE DEEP — NO TIME

00:00. Black. From this first frame the picture is already coming up, too slowly to see at first.

SOUND: Out of silence, a hiss like wind over open water, very faint, rising, with the dry crackle of pouring sand in it and a low swell under it. It is heard a little before anything is seen.

00:00 to 00:10. The static comes up out of the black: grain like fine sand, edge to edge, only brighter by the second. No shape in it. It does not flow yet.

00:10. Black and white static fills the frame, edge to edge, at full strength. No shape in it.

SOUND: The hiss is at its full level from 00:09: wide, and nothing else.

00:14. The static begins to flow: a current, with eddies in it, like wind over a map, or sand blown over a dune. The grain is unchanged. Only its motion changes.

00:16. Where it flows, something is rising under it: a human face, centre frame, eyes closed, expressionless, like a face pressed up under a sheet of pouring sand. Nothing draws it. The grains run around its brow, its nose, its lips and the hollows of its eyes, and catch the light on one side of each, so the features are there and not just the outline. If the sand stopped running, the face would sink back into it. By 00:27 it is unmistakable.

SOUND: Before the face can be seen, the hiss finds it. In the middle of the field a part of the noise moves differently: the same hiss, shaped like breath through an open mouth and throat. A whisper with no words in it, centred where the face is. Most people will feel it before they see the face.

00:26. The picture does not change.

SOUND: The whisper draws in, and the whole hiss draws in with it. It narrows and climbs, slowly, like a breath being drawn in that doesn't stop. It keeps climbing for twelve seconds. The picture gives no warning.

00:38:00. TWO FRAMES: the whole field of sand is pressed onto the face like a sheet in a gale, and every contour of the face shows through it.

00:38:02 to 00:38:10. The sand is blasted away from us, into the picture: it streaks inward toward the head, whips

around it and shuts behind it. It takes the dark with it. The face it leaves is white, lit as a real face is lit.

SOUND: At the top of the climb, everything lets go at once. A hit with real weight under it: a distorted sub-bass impact, the body of the blast. Then the tail: the static itself, pitched and smeared, passing the ears front to back and shutting behind the head as the picture shows it. The release is the loudest thing in the sequence by a wide margin, twenty decibels over the hiss. Then nothing: a true silence.

00:38:10 to 00:44:12. Black. Silence. The white face alone, eyes closed, where the static was. Six seconds. Nothing moves.

00:44:12. Its eyes open, and its mouth, a little. In the same frame, not after, the black around it gathers into a second face (beat 3).

SOUND: Out of the last resonance of the tail, one clear note, very quiet. It holds. It will not stop for four minutes.

00:46. Two faces, one frame. The small white face has moved aside, to the left. The second is far larger, off to the right and turned toward it, not behind it: black on black, lit only by the small face's light, seen only by its edges and creases, and it is the same face. Its brows are down and its mouth is a smile: malice. The small white face sees it: brows up, mouth open in a frown: fear.

00:46 to 00:57. Both climb, and nothing else moves. The large face's malice widens into glee and the glee into a wide, open-mouthed laugh: the face of something that believes it is everything, past all reason. The small face's fear becomes terror. The brows hold; the mouths open.

SOUND: From 00:52 the hiss comes back under the note in hard pulses, in the rhythm of laughter. No voice. The pulses grow with the laugh.

00:57 to 00:58:12. At the height of it the dark face comes for the white one, and reaches it.

00:58:12. At the touch, everything turns over, both faces together: a front of light runs out from where they meet and crosses the frame in half a second, fast but not a cut. Behind it the ground is white. The small face is dark, brows down, mouth in a frown: upset, unsatisfied. The large face around it is white on white, brows up, mouth in a smile: compassion. It doesn't strike. It tends the small one.

SOUND: The pulses stop dead on the turn. The note, low.

00:58:12 to 01:08. Both settle. The upset eases into peace, and the compassion into the same peace, until the two faces wear one expression. At 01:05:12 their eyes begin to close. At 01:08 both faces are asleep.

01:08. It turns back, whole frame, as a front of dark: dark ground. The small face wakes white, already afraid; the large face is already laughing. 01:10: the blow lands and we see it; the turn: white ground, dark face, the hurt tended, both sinking toward sleep. 01:11:12: dark. 01:12:14: light. Each turn is quicker than the last and goes further: the laugh wider, the terror sharper, the peace sooner, the sleep deeper.

SOUND: The note climbs a fifth. Each turn ticks. Each dark phase brings the laugh's pulses back, shorter each time.

01:11 to 01:15. The change stops taking the whole frame. It spreads: the turn runs through the ground in uneven fronts, like ink in water or frost over glass, and leaves patches of every shape and size, each turning on its own beat. The patches crack into smaller ones, like mud drying. Each patch keeps the faces in its own state, so the faces themselves break up into the patches; nothing is laid over them. Never in lines. Never in a grid.

SOUND: The ticks multiply into a granular shimmer, each grain on its own beat.

01:13 to 01:17. The faces have turned so fast that every expression is on them at once. They blur into one grey.

01:15 to 01:24. Black and white are the size of grains and the frame is a sea of them, shimmering, never flashing. Where two grains meet, a spark of colored light flares and dies: the first color in the sequence. More of them every second, and a faint sheen like a soap film drifts over the whole sea.

SOUND: From 01:17, pitched grains inside the shimmer: the first color has the first pitches.

01:17 to 01:23. Where the faces were there is a single grey grain like all the others. We stay on it.

01:24 to 01:28. The picture has been flat until now. It opens: the grains have distance between them, near ones and far ones, and we move in among them. There is room.

01:28 to 01:44. The wildest part of the sequence. Grains appear in pairs and vanish in pairs, every flash a color. The sea is so thick with light that nothing can be seen through it for more than a moment. It folds, streams, gathers into patterns and loses them, always organic. Nothing holds still except our particle, centre frame, white, steady. It is restless: it darts and doubles back. It is alone. Behind the sea, far off, a boundary that

never ends: the edge of a fractal, the Mandelbrot set's, which we fall toward and never reach; every fold opens into more folds. It fades as the land comes.

SOUND: Every flash is a blip whose pitch is its color and whose place is its place in the frame. Thousands of them. The note holds under all of it, an octave up.

01:44 to 01:47. Two others come in from far off and meet ours. The three lock together, circling so fast they read as one body. For the first time, something in this sea holds its shape: a proton. 01:47 to 01:49: the three settle, two above and one below. It is never drawn as a face.

SOUND: Two more voices lock onto the note: a fifth and an octave. They hold.

01:47 to 01:53. All through the sea the same thing happens at once. The surround is protons now. The flashes thin out. The pairs stop coming.

01:51 to 01:54. A smaller, quicker thing falls in around ours and stays, circling: an atom. Everywhere the same.

SOUND: A high ping on each orbit of the small thing, everywhere, thinning as the glare goes.

01:53 to 02:02. The glare that filled everything clears. For the first time we can see a long way. What we see is gas, even and faintly glowing, in every direction.

02:02 to 02:12. The gas is not quite even, and what is uneven grows. It draws together along threads. The threads branch and join like roots, like the veins of a leaf, and where they cross, knots swell like buds. Nothing is pushing it.

SOUND: A pad of low harmonics swells under the note as the threads draw.

02:12 to 02:20. The buds light: first one, then all along the threads, points of fierce blue-white coming on in the dark. Some burn out and burst, a ring going out from them, and what they throw off gathers nearby and lights again.

SOUND: Each ignition a bright attack; each burst a low boom, at the stars' own times.

02:20 to 02:24. We fall into one of them. The glare fills the frame.

SOUND: A rising roar.

02:24 to 02:32. Inside, it is violent. Orange-white glare. The electron is torn away from ours at 02:24:12 and flung off. The sea around us is bare nuclei slamming past in

every direction. At 02:26:12 ours hits another and holds. At 02:28:12 it hits a third: a flash. From that collision a photon comes off at 02:30, a white point leaving the centre, and we go with it. The glare slides away behind us.

SOUND: Two impacts. The roar drops away as we leave. The note goes very high and pure: it belongs to the photon now.

02:32 to 02:36. Black, and speed. Faint points stream past. The photon, centre frame, a white point.

SOUND: Quiet, for the first time since the release: only the one held note.

02:33:12 to 02:42. Ahead, a point of dull red. It grows. As we close on it, it cools: crust, cloud, then ocean, blue-grey from edge to edge, with bare dark land standing out of it. These are the first ordinary colors in the sequence.

SOUND: As the world fills the frame, the first real sound: a wind, faint.

02:42 to 02:43:12. Down through cloud: white, thinning to the sea's surface coming up fast.

02:43:12. Through the surface. A flash of blue.

SOUND: A muffled whoosh, and everything goes underwater.

02:43:12 to 02:46. Green-lit water, light in rays from above. A single cell grows at the centre as we close on it, round and steady. At 02:46 the light reaches it and it takes the light in.

02:46 to 02:57. The cell is the face now: round, steady, centre frame. The water around it runs through days and nights in a flicker that quickens. It divides. Again. Again, faster each time. We stay with one line of descent; the others drift off behind.

SOUND: Water, low and close. Each division a soft pop.

02:57 to 03:04. Something much larger closes around our cell from the left and swallows it whole. It is not digested. It settles inside and goes on dividing in step with its host, and the two are one creature.

03:04 to 03:08. These divide and hold together: clumps, a sheet, a body with a front and a back.

03:08 to 03:12. A small, soft, swimming thing with a rod down its back and, at the front, two eyes, looking at us. It is the first face since the beginning that really is one.

03:12 to 03:15:12. A fish. Behind it something far bigger slides across the frame: armored, jawed, the length of a boat. Ours darts up and away and gets clear.

SOUND: A deep pass under everything.

03:15:12 to 03:18. It keeps to the shallows now, near the light. Seen from below, through the bright skin of the surface, small shadows flicker across the sky. They have wings.

SOUND: Wingbeats, through water.

03:18 to 03:24. Shallows, mud, air. Daylight, warm. Fins that push like legs. The creature hauls out of the water on the right onto a shore where nothing like it has walked, and keeps going. The air over the shallows is alive with wings, insects glinting in the sun. Plants hold their shapes. The world has almost stopped shimmering.

SOUND: Surf. Insects.

03:24 to 03:27. It is lizard-shaped now, low and quick, running among ferns.

03:27 to 03:33. Night. A moon. Enormous animals, columns for legs, their bodies above the frame. Birds asleep in a branch. Something with long leathery wings crosses the moon. At their feet, in short bursts, a small furred sharp-nosed creature.

SOUND: Crickets. A low hush.

03:33 to 03:35. The small creature is on the body of a great animal that has died: a huge horned head lying on its side in the ferns, the frill up. It picks beetles off it.

03:35 to 03:36:12. The small creature's face fills the frame: whiskers, black eyes, ears up. Listening.

03:36:12 to 03:38:12. Low in the south a glow comes up where no dawn should be. It climbs. The creature goes still.

SOUND: A rumble, below hearing at first, climbing.

03:38:12 to 03:39:12. The ground heaves under it. The frame shakes.

SOUND: The quake.

03:39:12 to 03:42. The sky starts to fall: one streak of fire, then dozens, then the whole sky streaming down, and the air grows hot. The creature runs for a hole among the roots of a tree. We don't go with it. We stay on the dead animal's face.

SOUND: The roar, and under it, still, the note.

03:42 to 03:44. On the dead animal's face, the last of the fire still falling. Time runs: it is the last time the world moves faster than we can follow. The fire stops falling.

03:44 to 03:48. The sky goes dark and stays dark. Ash settles on the face. The flesh goes. The skull shows.

SOUND: The roar fades to wind. A long hush.

03:46:12 to 03:49. The skull sinks into the ground.

03:49 to 03:52. The sky clears. The first green to come back is ferns, everywhere: the same ferns the lizard-shaped creature ran through. Then the land greens differently: flowering things, and trees. Animals pass as blurs.

03:52 to 03:54. Where the head lay, a shoot. It is a sapling, then a tree, in two seconds.

03:54 to 03:58. One leaf comes loose and falls into frame, slowly, rocking from side to side the way a real leaf falls. It settles on the earth.

03:58 to 04:00. Everything is still. Two seconds.

SOUND: Wind, and the note. Nothing else.

04:00 to 04:01:12. Feet. A crowd of them, running, straight over the leaf, from right to left. The rush of them whips the leaf up into the air and away, tumbling, in a kick of dust: the stillness is over.

SOUND: Feet. People shouting, wild, without words: the first human voices.

04:01:12 to 04:03. We pull back and go with them: a band of early humans, men and women, with spears and tools, in forest. Something is chasing them, or they are chasing something.

04:03 to 04:36. From here the band never stops moving, and neither do we. The view travels beside them; they cross the frame right to left the whole way; whatever happens to them happens on the move. North is screen left: we face east the whole way.

The world is ordinary now: real light, real color, real sound. Only time still skips. Each time the view passes behind a tree, it is their children, then theirs. We are always on a face, the one nearest the centre, and through all the generations it is nearly the same face.

04:10 to 04:14. The forest thins to open woodland. They fight a big cat: it comes at them from behind, a running fight that never stops heading left, and the cat goes down behind them.

04:17 to 04:20. They fight another band coming the other way. It is ugly and fast, and they keep going.

04:22 to 04:26. Grassland. A newborn is passed along the moving line from one pair of hands to the next, leftward, and nobody stops.

04:27 to 04:30:12. A woman kneels at the edge of the path over a small grave, pushes the last of the earth over it, gets up and walks on. She looks back once. The grave slides out of the frame behind them.

04:30 to 04:36. Dry country, and a river running north through it, high and wide and green on both banks: reeds and papyrus, trees along the water, hippos in the shallows, birds everywhere. They follow it.

SOUND: The river. Birds. Feet.

04:36 to 04:38. They come up onto the edge of a cliff and stop. For the first time since the leaf, nobody is moving.

04:38 to 04:46. Nothing is sped up and nothing is cut. Below them the valley opens, and the river comes apart like a hand into many channels, braiding across a wide plain to the horizon. Green runs along every channel and spreads between them: reed beds, pools, open woodland. Mist lies over it in the early light. A flock lifts off the water in its thousands, turns, and settles again. Nobody has planted anything down there. The band stands and looks. Nobody speaks.

SOUND: Wind. Their breathing. Wings. The note, which has not stopped since the first face's eyes opened.

04:46 to 04:53. We move in, slowly, on one of them. We have seen this face before, at the very start, in the static. The morning light is on it.

04:53 to 04:58:12. The note fades under the wind. The face draws a breath in: the chin lifts a little, the mouth opens a little, and the breath goes on.

SOUND: One breath, drawn in, and not let out.

04:56 to 04:59. Closer: the eye, with the river in it, the channels reflected on its surface.

04:58:20 to 04:59:06. In the dark of the pupil, for an instant, the grain of the static.

04:59:08. Black, on the held breath.

CUT TO:

INT./EXT. THE GARDEN — THE FIRST SHOT OF 2:8